

NENO — EVIDENCE APPENDIX

Public evidence reviewed 29 August 2026

Scope. This appendix supports the seven-slide Executive Brief. It separates company claims, independent reporting, legal/terms evidence and Evidence Axis inference. No claim requires a LinkedIn screenshot.

Evidence labels

Label	Meaning
FACT — independent	Reported by a non-vendor publication or independent review/source.
FACT — primary	Directly stated by the company/product/legal source.
VENDOR CLAIM	A number or performance statement from the company itself; not independently validated unless another source is shown.
GUARDRAIL	A boundary that prevents overstatement or false equivalence.
INFERENCE	Evidence Axis interpretation drawn from the facts above; not presented as fact.

1. Trigger used in the brief

Claim used	Source class	Handling
Neno raised €6.6M Seed on 25 Aug 2026, led by AlleyCorp with Motive Partners and Firstminute Capital participating.	Company primary	FACT — primary
Neno plans significant Dutch commercial-team investment in Q4 2026 and Q2 2027, with localized GTM and partner integrations.	Company primary	FACT — primary / timing trigger
Neno says the Netherlands is the market to win and defend before additional EU expansion in H2 2027.	Company primary	FACT — primary / decision exposure
Neno publicly asks: who are we taking share from today, and where can we draw more from?	Company primary	Quoted as the company's own decision question; not a finding.

2. Neno differentiation claims used as context

Neno public claim	Handling
Real-time agentic general ledger unifying business bank accounts, corporate cards, bill payments and receivables.	FACT — primary; not independently validated in this brief.
AI agents handle reconciliation and tax categorization; in-house accountants review and approve output before final processing.	FACT — primary; used to define the service/accountability layer.
Neno describes a “done-for-you” state of work across reconciliation, compliance and reporting, with accountants accessible via Slack or WhatsApp.	FACT — primary; used to define the candidate outcome layer.

3. Finding A — Exact is closing the easy part of the gap

Finding statement: AI / agent automation is becoming a weaker shorthand for differentiation because Exact is already embedding named agents into core accounting workflows at meaningful installed-base scale.

Evidence point	Source class	Status	Why it matters
Exact publicly names four accounting AI agents: Purchase, Bank, Support and Debtor.	Exact product page	FACT — primary	AI agents are part of the current product surface, not an external concept.
Purchase Agent automates invoice processing and GL suggestions; Exact states 98% accuracy.	Exact product page	VENDOR CLAIM	Shows automation inside a core accounting workflow.
Bank Agent matches bank transactions to invoices and ledger accounts; Exact states it monitors more than 100M transactions per month this way.	Exact product page	VENDOR CLAIM	Shows vendor-reported operating scale in bank reconciliation.
ICT Magazine reports Exact CPO Joep Hoeks saying Purchase Agent is used in the administration of more than 100,000 companies.	Independent trade publication / executive interview	FACT — independent / attributed	Independent source confirms meaningful Purchase Agent adoption.
The same interview reports Debtor Agent use in more than 10,000 administrations.	Independent trade publication / executive interview	FACT — independent / attributed	Shows additional agent adoption beyond invoice processing.
“AI-native vs legacy” is therefore a weaker GTM shorthand than a comparison based on outcome ownership and accountable service.	Evidence Axis	INFERENCE	This is the decision implication, not a factual claim about buyer behavior.

Guardrail. The brief does not claim Exact has reproduced Neno’s full done-for-you accountant model. The finding is narrower: task/agent automation inside the incumbent core is moving faster than a static “legacy software” frame implies.

4. Finding B — adjacent platforms are compressing the back-office bundle

Finding statement: Qonto and Shine/Cegid are not treated as like-for-like Neno substitutes. They matter because each is broadening the finance-admin bundle around Dutch SMEs from an adjacent position.

Qonto evidence

Evidence point	Source class	Status	Boundary
Tech.eu reports Qonto has 600,000+ SME/freelance customers and operates in the Netherlands among eight EU markets.	Independent publication	FACT — independent	Confirms Dutch-market relevance and scale.
Tech.eu describes Qonto as combining business banking, corporate cards, bookkeeping tools, expense management and short-term financing in one hub.	Independent publication	FACT — independent	Supports the “bundle expansion” framing.
Qonto Netherlands support says Operator and Analyst AI agents are integrated into accounts and available to all plans/users on web and mobile.	Company support article	FACT — primary	Confirms named agent deployment in the Dutch product.
Qonto NL support lists integrations with Exact Online, Moneybird, AFAS, e-Boekhouden.nl, Minox, Yuki, Twinfield and Odoo.	Company support article	FACT — primary	Shows Qonto sits directly beside the Dutch accounting stack.
An independent Dutch business-banking review confirms a Dutch IBAN, accountant access and bookkeeping integration.	Independent Dutch review	FACT — independent	Second independent source for local-market presence / finance-admin positioning.
Qonto acquired Acasi assets to add integrated certified accounting for French SMEs/freelancers.	Independent fintech publication	FACT — independent	Signals capability expansion.
Current evidence does not establish Acasi-certified accounting as live in the Netherlands.	Evidence Axis	GUARDRAIL	The brief does not claim Dutch certified accounting from Qonto.

Shine / Cegid evidence

Evidence point	Source class	Status	Boundary
Cegid closed its acquisition of Shine on 8 Jun 2026; the combined group is described as serving 1M+ SMBs and 15,000 accountants across European markets including the Netherlands.	Company announcement + transaction coverage	FACT — primary / attributed	Supports scale and consolidation direction.
Cegid/Shine describe a combined platform spanning e-invoicing, accounting, business accounts/payments, tax, HR and payroll.	Company primary	FACT — primary	Supports the bundle-convergence thesis.
Independent Dutch reviews list Shine/Tellow as Dutch bookkeeping software for freelancers and small businesses.	Independent Dutch reviews	FACT — independent	Two non-vendor sources support Dutch competitive-set relevance.
Shine NL product pages cover invoicing, bookkeeping, VAT, expenses and payroll.	Company primary	FACT — primary	Confirms current Dutch product surface.
Shine Terms say the platform does not act as the subscriber’s accountant, tax adviser, auditor or legal representative.	Company legal terms	FACT / GUARDRAIL	Prevents treating Shine as equivalent to Neno’s accountable service layer.
For Dutch subscribers, Shine Terms limit supported accounting method and exclude partial VAT schemes.	Company legal terms	FACT / GUARDRAIL	Further limits like-for-like equivalence.

5. Decision interpretation used in the Executive Brief

Observed movement	Evidence Axis interpretation
Exact has named AI agents with meaningful reported adoption inside accounting workflows.	The automation layer is converging; “AI-native” alone should not be assumed to remain a durable sales distinction.
Qonto combines Dutch business banking with bookkeeping/finance tooling and now exposes AI agents; certified accounting expansion is proven only in France.	Qonto can raise expectations for what a finance hub includes without being a Dutch like-for-like accounting-service substitute.
Shine is active in Dutch bookkeeping software, while Cegid is combining wider accounting / finance / HR capabilities; Shine’s legal terms keep accountability with the customer.	Shine/Cegid can compress parts of the bundle while still leaving a service/accountability gap relative to Neno’s public model.
Neno says it owns a real-time ledger and has in-house accountants approve outputs and deliver finished work.	The public differentiation worth testing shifts upward toward outcome ownership, system-of-record control and accountable human service.

Unknowns that remain. Public evidence cannot establish which competitor Nick Knuppe personally tracks, which claims win or lose in Neno sales calls, or which buyer segments value finished work most. Those questions require internal pipeline / win-loss evidence and are intentionally left for a paid decision sprint.

6. Source register

ID	Source	Class	URL
N1	Neno — Seed / product / GTM company update	Company primary	Open source
E1	Exact — accounting product / AI agents	Company primary	Open source
E2	ICT Magazine — interview with Exact CPO Joep Hoeks	Independent trade publication	Open source
Q1	Tech.eu — Qonto and Pennylane: friends and foes	Independent publication	Open source
Q2	Qonto NL — AI agents support article	Company support	Open source
Q3	Qonto NL — accounting integrations support article	Company support	Open source
Q4	FF News — Qonto acquires Acasi assets	Independent fintech publication	Open source
Q5	ZakelijkBankieren.nl — Qonto review 2026	Independent Dutch review	Open source
S1	Cegid — acquisition announcement / group scope	Company primary	Open source
S2	Morningstar / Business Wire — acquisition closing	Transaction coverage / release distribution	Open source
S3	Shine Netherlands — product page	Company primary	Open source
S4	Shine — Terms of Service	Company legal document	Open source
S5	Ondernemen & Internet — Shine review	Independent Dutch review	Open source
S6	Boekhouder.nl — Shine product review/listing	Independent Dutch review	Open source